

Yun (Evelina) Bao

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Computational social scientist specializing in NLP & LLM, social network, and user behavior on digital platform.

EDUCATION

New York University (GPA 3.95/4.00)

Ph.D. in Social Psychology, Minor in Quantitative Psychology

New York, NY

September 2022 – May 2027 (expected)

University of Southern California (GPA 3.91/4.00)

B.S. Computer Science (Major, GPA: 4.00/4.00)

Los Angeles, CA

August 2017 – May 2022

B.A. Psychology (Major, GPA: 3.96/4.00)

SKILLS

Computational Methods: *NLPs, LLMs, Social Network Analysis*, Text Analysis, Machine Learning

Coding & Data: *Python, R, SQL*, Java, JavaScript; MongoDB; *High-Performance Computing (HPC)*

Python ML Libraries: *scikit-learn, PyTorch, NumPy*, Pandas, HuggingFace Transformers, NetworkX

AI tools: GPT-4, Cursor, Copilot, Prompt Engineering

Statistical Methods: *Casual Inference, Time-series Model, Multilevel Model, Mixed-effects Model, SEM*

Research Methods: *Experiment Design & Survey*, Longitudinal studies, Usability Testing, A/B Testing

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

Harvard University

Cambridge, MA

Doctoral Researcher (Advisor: Dr. Ashwini Ashokkumar)

09/2024 - Present

- **Led a large-scale natural language processing project** analyzing 60M+ Reddit comments to study long-term shifts in shifts in **emotional well-being and collective identity** in response to societal disruptions.
- **Identified key predictors of positive user experiences** across time and regions, integrating natural language processing (e.g., topic modeling) and multilevel sequential time-series models.
- **Constructed and analyzed large-scale social networks** of TikTok users (based on co-follower structures) to map information flow, rhetoric diffusion patterns, influence pathways, and community clustering.
- **Integrated network topology with transformer-based language models** to examine how influencer messaging shapes downstream decision-making.
- **Developed clear, interpretable visualizations of complex behavioral and network data** to communicate insights to interdisciplinary and non-technical audiences.

Stanford University

Stanford, CA

Doctoral Researcher (Advisor: Dr. Madalina Vlasceanu)

09/2023 - Present

- **Built a human-AI analytical pipeline** where GPT-4 generated emotion inferences from user-generated text; benchmarked AI outputs against human annotations to evaluate LLM-human alignment in affective reasoning.
- **Designed an emotion-induction intervention to motivate climate belief and behavioral changes**; increased climate belief by 20%, policy support by 15%, and climate action intention by 10% across political ideologies.
- **Conducted large-scale randomized-controlled experiments (RCTs)** to examine the effect of interventions with a sample of 4000+ participants and analyzed the data in Python and R *using mixed-effect models and Bayesian analysis*, translating experimental findings into **applied behavior-change strategies**.

New York University

New York, NY

Doctoral Researcher (Advisor: Dr. Ajua Duker)

09/2022 - Present

- **Led a national, longitudinal panel study** (1,100+ participants, 5,000+ responses) during the 2024 US election; **developed predictive models of engagement, well-being, and emotional regulation**, integrating **multi-level models** to distinguish within-person vs. between-person reasoning processes.
- **Delivered data-driven recommendations** to emotion intervention to improve the well-being across demographics, using experiments and multivariate analyses to inform insights.

University of Southern California, mHealth Collaboratory

Los Angeles, CA

Undergraduate Researcher (Advisor: Dr. Susan Luczak; Dr. Donna Spruijt-Metz)

05/2019 – 08/2022

- **Built and deployed a digital health platform to track real-time health behaviors**, enabling remote data collection, randomized assignment, and longitudinal measurement.
- **Conducting in-depth user interviews and user studies** for a fitness app to identify user engagement patterns and synthesized qualitative data to deliver user-centered insights on motivation and drop-off points.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Bao, Y., Zhang, Y., & Wang, J. (2023) Exploring the relationship between exposure to COVID-19 and donations during the COVID-19 pandemic: The mediating roles of emotions and risk perception. *Frontiers in Psychology* 14:1052531. [doi: 10.3389/fpsyg.2023.1052531](https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2023.1052531)

Bao, Y. E. & Vlasceanu, M. (R&R at Journal of Experimental Psychology: Applied). Does Positive or Negative Emotion Increase Climate Mitigation Outcomes? Their combination! <https://bit.ly/4rV5Brx>

Bao, Y. E. & Ashokkumar, A. (in preparation). Large-scale, Long-lasting Psychological Shifts Led by COVID-19 Pandemic across the U.S. Revealed in Social Media Conversation. <https://bit.ly/4sYpLBE>